

and uncomfortable and resentful. He never sweated. He was one who liked it hot. But that was when he could say what was on his mind in ways he never could without walking. After I moved his office to San Mateo late in his career, he walked from home and back, and he said it was the most peaceful time he had ever known as an adult, walking through San Mateo's residential gardens, gazing at the bright flowers. He was a great walker, simply great. The man's body was staggering. Tough. He could walk forever on legs that wouldn't quit no matter what, no matter how far or how steep the hill. He loved it.

I live and work on top of a two-thousand-foot-tall redwood-covered mountain overlooking the Pacific Ocean. I have lived there thirty years, and I have two hundred of my five hundred people up there at headquarters. And I own a stunning mountain-top ranch property nearby that is the only in-holding inside a five-thousand-acre open-space preserve. Once when father was eighty, he and my twelve-year-old son, Nathan, and I left the rest of the extended family at the ranch and started downhill, toward the Pacific, through the trees on the trails into the heart of Purisima Canyon. Father whistled and talked as if he were a boy. No worries. Walking. Walking purged worry. I've been a mountain man in this area most of my life and know it exceptionally well, and my legs are used to hills from living here. At every trail junction, I would say, "Now Father, this way is the shorter, less steep, quicker way to get back, and that way is the longer, further-down-in-the-canyon, steeper way. Which way do you want to take?" At every junction, he chose the harder, longer way. We dropped thirteen hundred feet in elevation and walked five miles, at which point we had to get back up. I was a bit worried. When we stopped, Father wasn't walking, so he would start to worry. And he could worry about nothing at all and turn it into a big worry. And right then he worried that my mother would be worried that we were stranded and hurt in the woods because it was taking us so long to get back. Nathan, raised on the mountain, scampered ahead like a darting deer. As the sun started setting, Father fretted more and wanted us to pick up the pace. Of course, my mother wasn't worried. She wasn't the worrying kind. That's what he liked—walking, worrying, and work.

One of the best times I ever had with my father came about by serendipity. I was fourteen. The family—Mother, Father, Donald, and I—were having a Wyoming-dude-ranch summer vacation. Arthur was gone from home by